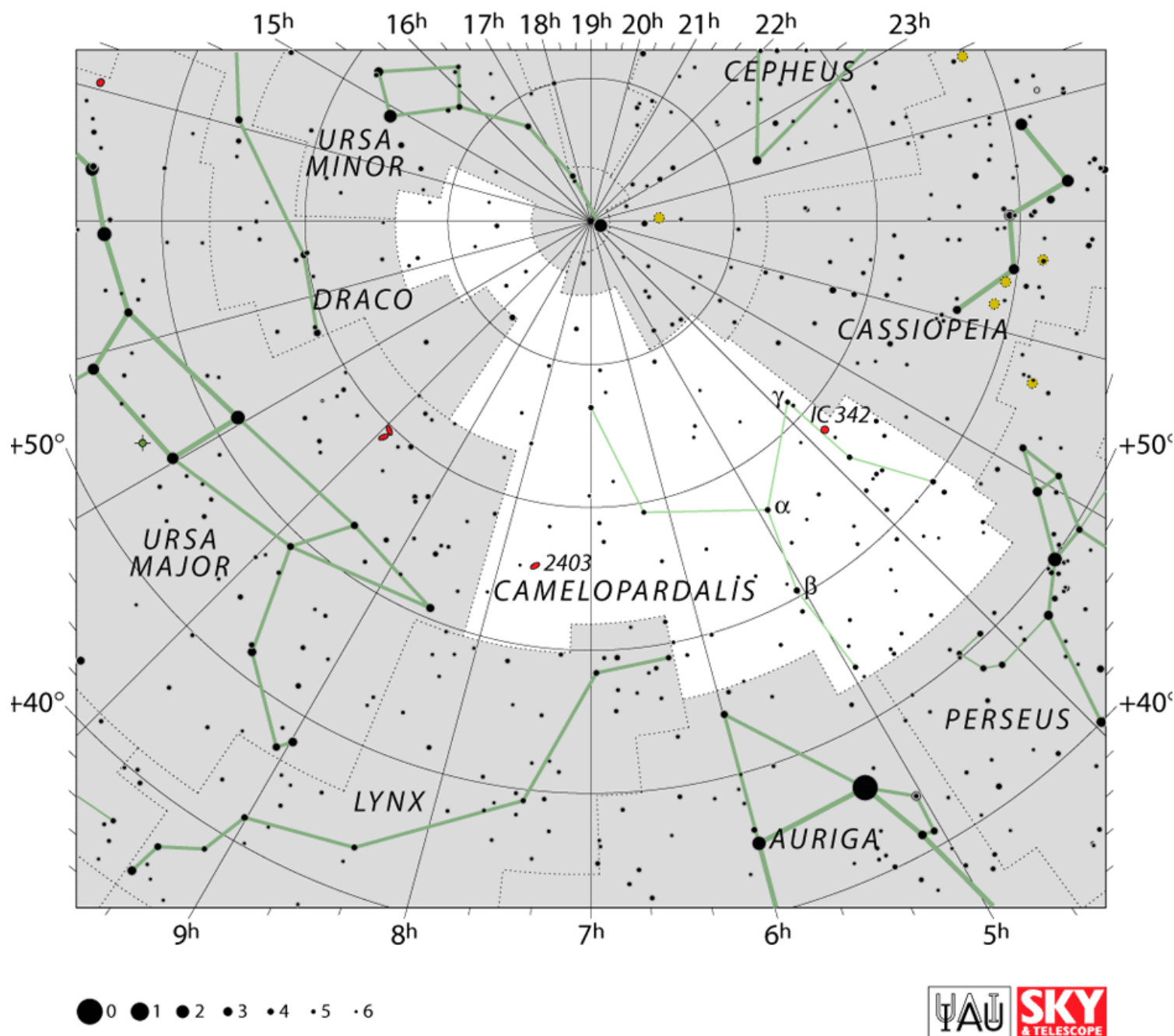




Map of Camelopardalis

There are no bright stars in Camelopardalis; you might see a few dim 4th magnitude stars scanning between bright Capella in Auriga and the North Star. However, in this empty span of sky, there are several deep-sky objects (DSOs) that rival objects found in more well-known constellations.



One asterism is “Kemble’s Cascade” a trail of 5th-9th magnitude stars in a straight line midway between the W of Cassiopeia and the bright star Capella, visible in binoculars.

Things to See in Camelopardalis

While there aren't any of the "famous" DSOs in Camelopardalis, there are a few objects worth investigating.

Name	Type	Using
NGC 1502	Open Cluster	Binoculars, Small Telescope
NGC 1501	Planetary Nebula	Telescope
Caldwell 5 (IC 342)	Galaxy	Telescope
Caldwell 7 (NGC 2403)	Spiral Galaxy	Small Telescope
NGC 2146	Galaxy	Telescope
RU Cam	Cepheid Variable	Binoculars, Small Telescope

Jolly Roger Cluster

NGC 1502 is an open cluster located at the end of Kemble's Cascade with about 45 stars located about 2,700 light years from Earth.



NGC 1502

The Oyster Nebula

Also nearby, the small but intricate NGC 1501, a planetary nebula 4,240 light years distant spanning 0.5 light years across.

The Hidden Galaxy

"Hidden" because it's close to the dusty areas of the galactic plane, large, but relatively faint (like M33), this close-by galaxy (10.7 Mly) is a challenging but rewarding object.



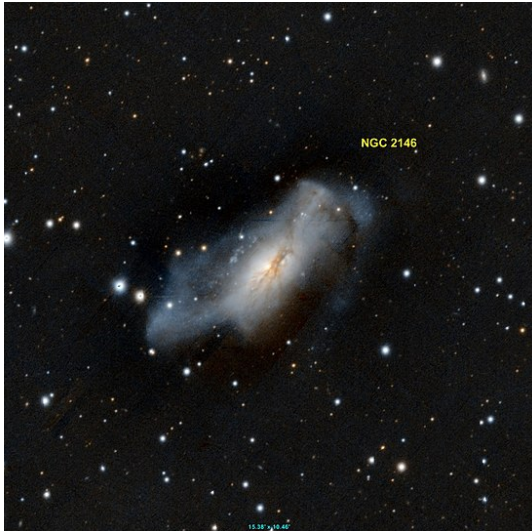
Hay Creek Observatory

Caldwell 7 (NGC 2403)

An outlying member of the M81 Group, and 10 million light years distant, this galaxy is reachable with 10x50 binoculars in dark skies. It also contains the giant nebula NGC 2404 almost 1000 light years wide.



NGC 2403



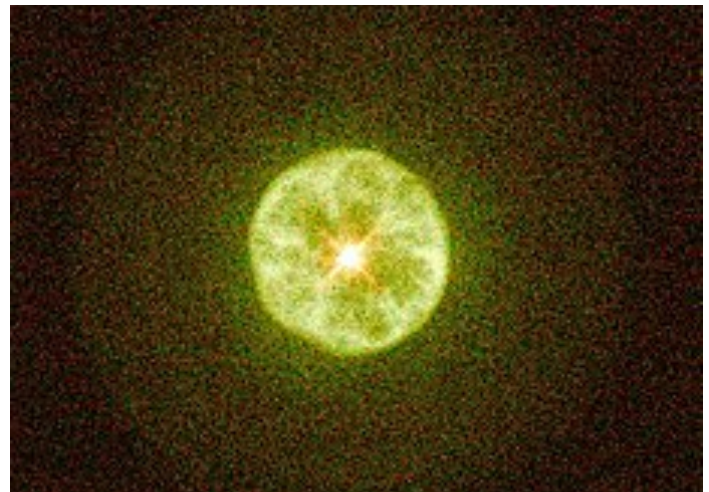
As seen by Hubble

The Dusty Hand

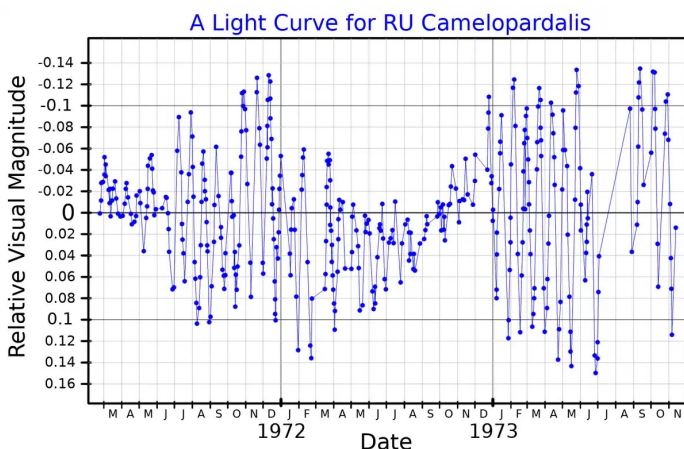
The barred spiral galaxy NGC 2146 is interesting because of the dark dusty lanes of its twisted spiral arm, likely caused by the interaction of a satellite galaxy 0.5 billion years ago.

The Lemon Slice

Named from a false-color Hubble image (it's not really yellow), this almost perfectly spherical planetary nebula is 4,500 light years distant, and about 0.2 light-years in diameter. It was discovered in 1900 by Robert Aitken.



Hunter Wilson - CC 3.0



Mysterious RU Camelopardalis

Finally, a variable star to learn about. RU Cam is a type II Cepheid that is in a stage of evolution putting it right at the edge of the “instability strip”. For the most part, it varies between mag 8 and 10 over 17-27 days. However, it occasionally almost stops pulsating for months at a time. As it evolves, it'll first become hotter/bluer, then eventually become cooler/redder. We catching it right now in this sort of transitional phase.